The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Jambhala

Āryajambhalanāmāṣṭaśataka · Toh 972 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་གནོད་འཇིན་གྲུབ་ཆོན་བར་རྒྱ་ཚ་རྒྱས་པ་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Jambhala, known in Sanskrit as Ārya Jambhala Nāma Aṣṭaśataka and in Tibetan as Phakpa Nödzin gyi Tsen Gya Tsa Gyepa, is a short work in verse devoted to Jambhala, the yakṣa deity associated with wealth and prosperity. It opens in the realm of Alakāvatī, where a radiant yakṣa adorned with gold and jewels clasps the feet of Vajradhara, the Lord of Secrets. With a composed mind, he praises Vajradhara as protector of beings and holder of the secret of all the buddhas, and asks for a teaching to benefit sentient beings, which leads into a litany of names celebrating Jambhala's qualities and powers. The text is Toh 972 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of name-praises and dhāraṇī-related works found among the tantric texts of the canon.

In the language of India: ārya jambhala nāma aṣṭaśataka
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Jambhala.

Homage to the noble Jambhala.

Then the yakṣa who dwells in the wilderness,
well adorned with pure gold,
exquisitely beautiful with jewels,
like a fire blazing fiercely,
while dwelling in Alakāvatī,
took firm hold of the two feet
of Vajradhara, Lord of Secrets,
and, his mind deeply composed, asked:

"Blessed One, mighty king over Jambhala,
lord of all the hosts of secret mantra,
worshipped by all the holders of vidyā-mantras,
to whom gods and asuras bow,
diligent in taming the vicious,
endowed with the qualities of a bodhisattva,
protector who acts for the benefit of all beings,
holder of the secret of all the buddhas:
because I wish to help sentient beings,
with a mind overwhelmed by compassion,

for the sake of perfect, complete awakening
I too have generated the mind of awakening.
Seeing that humans have little wealth,
scant merit and little power,
I am tormented by great suffering,
O Lord of Secrets."

When Jambhala had spoken thus,
the Blessed One, the secret Lord of Secrets,
overwhelmed by compassion, said:

"Listen well, guhyaka,
glorious protector Jambhala,
you who act for the benefit of all beings
and dispel the afflictions of poverty.
The hundred and eight names, endowed with merit,
of the lord of all wealth,
which dispel the evil fault of poverty,
were spoken in the past by supreme victors
as numerous as the sands of the Ganges.
In the field called Hundred Rays,
when the Buddha Sun Face
was teaching the Dharma, I myself
formerly heard it with my own ears.
It dispels poverty and is endowed with merit;
through my wisdom I shall teach it well
to you who strive for the benefit of all beings.
Listen with your mind fully composed.

Noble one, superior of gods and asuras,
endowed with wisdom, respectful toward the Dharma,
compassionate by nature, patient and steadfast,
with senses at peace, with senses subdued,
virtuous, destroyer of evil, conscientious,
gentle, accomplisher of every aim,
harmless, undeceiving, glorious,
lord of treasuries, invincible to others,
whose sole refuge is the Three Jewels,
watched over by all the buddhas,

guardian of treasures, majestic,
ever-giving, increaser of wealth,
source of jewels, tamer of people,
lord of the waters, sender of rain,
yakṣa whose nature is to move through water,
revealer of the treasures,
golden mountain, Meru,
liberator from the graha of poverty,
Indra, Upendra, protector of beings,
lord of the waters, cloud-colored,
eye of the world and superior of the world,
sun and moon, the constant one,
great wealth, great king,
in whose hand the mongoose firmly rests,
youth with the lion crest,
great yakṣa of great miraculous power,
lord of speech, with smiling face,
who speaks honestly and sweetly,
brahmin, hook that draws in what is desired,
great one, accomplisher of aims, worshipped by siddhas,
expounder of vidyā-mantras, wheel-turning monarch,
Kubera, rider upon a man,
pot-bellied and wide-eyed,
with divine fragrance, swift as the mind,
pervading lord, source of bliss, son of Excellent Wealth,
delighting in protecting sentient beings,
taking whatever form he wishes, god of the mind,
the crowned one who delights in his lineage,
with crown on the left side, staff in hand,
hundred-handed, of great strength,
lord of the eight grounds, dweller in the gods' realm,
whose face is the color of the full moon,
caravan leader, Gaṇapati,
elder, merchant, fortunate one,
wish-fulfilling jewel, excellent vase,
wish-granting tree, lord of men,
supreme, worthy aim, chief,

granter of the supreme, the dwarf, Viṣṇu,
worthy refuge, guardian of auspiciousness,
fully adorned with garlands of jewels,
seated upon a divine lion throne,
bodhisattva, lord of glory,
exceedingly fierce, of inexhaustible wealth,
with the might of a lion's prowess,
teacher victorious over the three worlds,
chief, supreme of the merchant caste,
lotus-naveled, invincible victor,
practitioner of celibacy, great ocean.

These hundred and eight names
of the great Jambhala that I have taught
destroy every evil
and dispel the afflictions of poverty;
they bring forth prosperity and good fortune,
increase elephants, horses and wealth,
and dispel the planets and lunar mansions,
bad dreams and evil omens.
Whether in a forest or in a village,
in a charnel ground or on a mountain,
wherever the wise one recites them,
there people are made fully safe
from battle and fearsome enemies,
from snakes, fire, water, thieves, robbers and the like,
from tigers and bears, from great terrors,
and from the dreadful ocean, so hard to cross.
Indra, Agni and Varuṇa,
Yama, Nairṛti lord of the rākṣasas, and Vāyu,
the wealth-giver, glorious Kubera,
Maṇibhadra, Pāñcika,
the Playful One and Āṭavaka,
and other gods and yakṣas as well,
without slackening, day and night,
gladly stand guard.
Wherever these names are recited,

elephants, horses and cattle,
crops of every kind,
fruits and flowers all increase.
Human diseases and contagious diseases,
all that arise from every harm,
everywhere turn to well-being,
and above all it is auspicious for children.
Pretas and nāgas,
mātṛkās and fierce grahas,
ḍākinīs and kinnaras,
and rākṣasas do that person no harm.
He is freed from every disease,
and likewise is happy and wealthy,
flourishing with sons and grandsons,
with glory and with generosity.
He is born into a supreme and royal lineage
and into great wealth;
he comes to possess long life and glory,
and becomes free of disease and grahas.
In all his lives he remembers his births,
learns quickly and retains what he has heard,
is endowed with the qualities of a bodhisattva,
and becomes truly fortunate.

Homage, homage, lord of the yakṣas!
Lord of Secrets, homage to you,
diligent in taming the vicious,

Vajrapāṇi, I bow to you,
kind and pleased toward beings who have faith.
This renown of the son of Excellent Wealth,
which pacifies the disease of poverty,
has been well proclaimed and fully explained.
The secret mantra that accomplishes every aim
I too now offer here.
By merely recalling it well,
a person is freed from poverty,
is protected and cannot be assailed by others,

is not overcome even by enemies,
is fortunate and endowed with good fortune,
and lives even for a hundred years.
A divine elephant and jewels,
victory and all that befits a kingdom,
he will certainly and swiftly obtain,
and kingship too, without any doubt.

namo ratnatrayāya namo maṇibhadrāya mahāyakṣasenāpataye oṃ hrīṃ hrīṃ kṣā jroṃ hrāṃ hrāṃ dībya ratrau gavariśana atavāka deva yakṣa samaya manusmar hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

The Hundred and Eight Names of the Noble Jambhala is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The opening epithet "the yakṣa who dwells in the wilderness" recalls the yakṣa Āṭavaka, but here it describes the speaker, Jambhala. In the protector list, the similar name rendered Āṭavaka is identified with some hesitation. The line "Blessed One, mighty king over Jambhala" is ambiguous in the Tibetan. The field "Hundred Rays," the buddha "Sun Face," "the Playful One" and "son of Excellent Wealth" are translated literally because their Sanskrit forms could not be securely identified. "Conscientious" renders an obscure word. In "born into great wealth" the text reads "disease," which is taken as a slip for "into, within." In the protector list, "lord of the rākṣasas" (srin bdag) is taken as Nairṛti, the guardian of the southwest, who stands between Yama and Vāyu in the standard sequence of world protectors.
• The line "this renown of the son of Excellent Wealth" is uncertain. The genitive is rendered literally. The line may instead mean "this renown of the son, Excellent Wealth." The mantra itself invokes Maṇibhadra, the yakṣa general.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.